

SIX AIRBAGS A MUST IN ALL INDIAN CARS

Union minister of road transport and highways, Nitin Gadkari has tweeted that a draft notification has been passed to make six airbags compulsory for vehicles in India. This comes after the ministry passed the mandate of making two airbags compulsory in vehicles, which came into force on January 1, 2022. The ministry is now pushing to make the rear occupants of vehicles safer, adding four airbags for the rear occupants increasing safety and decreasing fatal and non-fatal injuries. This mandate will apply to budget to mid-range vehicles that are not equipped with rear passenger airbags (most cars on sale under Rs 20 lakh only provide rear airbags and side curtain airbags for the top-spec variants). Needless to say, the mandate will make vehicles safer for occupants.

MAHINDRA XUV 700 WINS ICOTY 2022

The Mahindra XUV 700 has won the Indian Car of the Year 2022 award. The 17th edition of the ICOTY announced the Indian SUV as the winner, edging out nominees like the Volkswagen Taigun, Tata Punch, Citroen C5 Aircross, Force Gurkha, Maruti Suzuki Celerio, MG Astor, Renault Kiger, Skoda Kushaq and Skoda Octavia. The ICOTY jury awarded the XUV 700 101 points while the Volkswagen Taigun came in second with 89 points and the Tata Punch scored 71 points for third. Yogendra Pratap, Editor, *Auto Today* and chairman of the jury, ICOTY 2022, Dr. Raghupati Singhania, CMD, JK Tyre & Industries Ltd along with the other members of the jury, handed over the trophy to M&M Ltd's Veejay Nakra, CEO, automotive division, Satinder Singh Bajwa, senior vice-president & head, sales & customer care, automotive division, and Harish Lalchandani, vice-president, marketing, automotive division, M&M Ltd.



TVS RAIDER IS THE IMOTY 2022



TVS Raider 125 has been crowned the Indian Motorcycle of the Year 2022. Other motorcycles shortlisted for the award included the new Royal Enfield Classic 350, Honda CB200X, Yamaha FZ-X, Bajaj Pulsar F250, and Bajaj Pulsar N250. Aspi Bathena, Editor, *Bike India* and chairman of the jury, IMOTY 2022, along with other jury members and Dr Raghupati Singhania, CMD, JK Tyre & Industries Ltd, handed over the trophy to TVS Motors' Aniruddha Haldar, senior vice-president, marketing, and Varghese M. Thomas, senior vice-president, corporate communication.